

Interstate coach terminus

Cost-benefit analysis

Private state-to-state station. Rent bays and night slots to private fleets. Do not buy the buses. Take rent plus shops, parking and ads — not the ticket. Everyday waves on the same concrete.

Prepared	August 2026
Planning capital	₦2.57 billion · ~2 ha highway-edge Lagos-Ogun
Y3 run-rate	₦960m gross · ₦542m EBITDA · ₦310m NPAT
Unlevered IRR	16% planning · -9% stress · 43% if land is a concession
NPV @ 22%	Planning -₦0.71bn · clears ~15% property hurdle
Eventual phases	6 hubs ₦11.7bn · Y12 NPAT ~₦0.95bn · IRR 12.7% — expand on concessions, not 36 copies

Rent the station · do not buy the buses

ILLUSTRATIVE

A private **state-to-state** terminus, open every day, sized so **morning, afternoon and night waves** reuse the same bays. Private fleets (GUO-class, mid-tier, new CNG lines) rent gates and layover. The owner takes **rent plus the station economy** (food, shops, parking, ads) — not the ticket, and not a 10–25% “loading tax” of the old motor park.

Field	Detail
Prepared	August 2026
Horizon	10 years unlevered, residual at year 10
Currency	Nigerian naira (₦), nominal
Planning site	~2.0 ha, highway-edge Lagos–Ogun (not Jibowu)
Planning capital	₦2.57 billion
Discount rates	22% (venture / high-risk); 18% and 15% (property)
Tax	32.1% of PBT (30% CIT + 3% education tax)
Classification	Illustrative planning note — not investment advice

Verdict in one line. The **shape** of the business is right (airport, not airline). On **bought** outer-Lagos land with 72% bay occupancy it **earns** (Y3 NPAT ~₦310m, IRR ~16%, payback ~7 years) but it **does not clear a 22% hurdle**. It **does** clear a ~15% property hurdle. It **fails** if you overpay for inner-city land or open empty. It **works well** if land is a **concession** and bays are **pre-let**. The **36 states** are on the **destination board**, not in the CapEx as 36 stations.

Contents

1. [The model](#)
2. [What it costs](#)
3. [What it returns](#)
4. [Cost-benefit](#)
5. [Versus owning the buses](#)
6. [The 36 states](#)
7. [Eventual phases](#)
8. [What the numbers do not capture](#)
9. [Go / no-go](#)
10. [Appendices](#)

1. The model

1.1 Who pays whom

You own	Tenant	You do not take
Land (or long concession), pavement, building, clock	Private interstate operators	The passenger ticket
Night power, security, toilets, lounges	Retail / food / ads concessionaires	A tout-style % of every fare
Optional later: CNG, wash, lodge	Park-and-ride / drop-off cars	The buses

Product. Contracted **bays** (monthly) + **casual slots** for overflow + **overnight layover** + **retail GLA** + parking + ads. Same 36 load bays work three times a day if the timetable is real.

Not this product. A LAMATA BRT terminal. A NURTW open park. A Jibowu-street of single-brand compounds you hope GIGM will abandon. A fleet.

1.2 Why “different times of day” is the economics

Sizing the yard for every operator’s fleet at 07:00 is how you bankrupt a station. Sizing for the **fattest wave** (often night + weekend) and **reusing bays** is how ₦2.6bn of concrete can earn. Night operations are not optional: that is a large part of interstate money.

1.3 What must be true before earthworks

1. Highway exit — a loaded coach must reach the express.
2. Written designation as an interstate load point (state / LASTMA / LGA).
3. **Signed slot contracts** covering at least **~40% of bays** (about 15 of 36 on planning).
4. 05:00–24:00 staffing and power.
5. You are the **Lagos (or Abuja) end**. Operators already have the other city.

If (3) fails, do not build.

1.4 What “state-to-state” includes — and what it does not

The 36 states are destinations, not 36 construction sites. Coaches already leave Lagos for the federation (East, Abuja, PH, Kano, Calabar, the West). One designated Lagos-end station **serves those routes**. That is how the 36 states sit in this CBA: **as demand on the timetable**, not as 36 copies of the ₦2.57bn yard.

Not in v1.0 of the numbers: 36 state governments as counterparties; a terminus in every capital; FCT as a second model; population-weighted demand by state. Those are Section 6.

2. What it costs

2.1 Planning-case capital (₦ million)

Highway-edge Lagos-Ogun, 20,000 m², 36 load bays, 2,500 m² terminal building, solar + generator, not a 10 ha mega-terminal.

Item	₦ million
Land (20,000 m ² × ₦38,000)	760
Paving / yard (16,000 m ² × ₦24,000)	384
Terminal building (2,500 m ² × ₦300,000)	750
Utilities (power, water, drainage, lighting, CCTV, fence/gates)	260
Fit-out (lounges, toilets, offices)	120
Design, preliminaries, contingency (14% of hard works)	212
Works subtotal	1,726
Pre-open working capital	80
Total uses	2,566

Build rates sit in 2026 warehouse / industrial bands (about ₦180k–₦350k/m² for buildings; paving lower). **Land is the swing factor.** ₦38,000/m² is an **outer corridor** price, not Jibowu and not Lekki Free Zone (serviced industrial land there has been listed around **\$250/m²**). If the site is inner Lagos, use the **stress** column.

Case	Land idea	Total CapEx
Stress	Inner-corridor freehold (~₦80,000/m ² , 1.8 ha)	₦3.74bn
Planning	Highway-edge Lagos-Ogun	₦2.57bn
Upside	Long public/private concession (little freehold)	₦2.01bn

Works depreciate over 20 years. Land is not depreciated. No debt in the base run.

2.2 Annual operating cost (planning, full run-rate)

About **¥418 million** a year at full occupancy: staff, contracted security, diesel/solar, maintenance (~2.8% of works), insurance (~1.5% of assets), LGA/rates/signage, lean HQ. Roughly half of that is **sticky** if buses stay away — which is why empty stations die.

3. What it returns

3.1 Planning steady revenue (year 3 onward)

72% of 36 bays contracted (~**26 bays**) at **¥1.8m** per bay per month. Casual slots and layover on top. Retail is **lease**, not a cut of fare.

Line	¥ million / year	Share
Contracted bays	560	58%
Casual / overflow departures	178	19%
Overnight layover	65	7%
Retail / food leases	97	10%
Parking / drop-off	36	4%
Advertising	24	3%
Gross	960	100%

Ramp: year 1 = 55% of that, year 2 = 80%, year 3+ = 100%. That is the “open empty” tax.

3.2 Planning P&L (¥ million)

	Y1	Y2	Y3 (run-rate)
Gross	528	768	960
Opex	339	383	418
EBITDA	189	385	542
EBITDA margin	36%	50%	56%
Depreciation	86	86	86
Tax	—	—	146
NPAT	70	203	310
NPAT margin	13%	26%	32%
Unlevered FCF	156	289	396

Y3 cash yield on **¥2.57bn**: **EBITDA / capital** ≈ **21%**. That is a property yield, not a kiosk fee stack.

3.3 Three cases (unlevered, 10 years, residual at Y10)

	Stress	Planning	Upside
CapEx	¥3.74bn	¥2.57bn	¥2.01bn
Bay occupancy	48%	72%	86%
Steady gross	¥378m	¥960m	¥1.76bn

	Stress	Planning	Upside
Y3 EBITDA	– ₦183m	₦542m	₦1.34bn
Y3 NPAT	– ₦292m	₦310m	₦852m
Unlevered IRR	– 9%	16%	43%
Payback	Never in 10y	~7.4 years	~2.9 years
NPV @ 22%	– ₦4.17bn	– ₦0.71bn	+₦2.61bn
NPV @ 18%	– ₦4.13bn	– ₦0.27bn	+₦3.71bn
NPV @ 15%	– ₦4.08bn	+₦0.16bn	+₦4.79bn

How to read this. At 22% (harsh, venture-style) planning is a **no**. At 15% (plausible for leased infrastructure with residual land) planning is a **thin yes**. Upside is “do not buy the dirt, concession it, and fill the bays.” Stress is “Jibowu prices, half-empty station” — a hole.

EBITDA break-even occupancy (volume lines scale together): about **23% of bays** on planning cost stack (~8 contracted bays) — **if** you actually cut variable cost. In stress, opex and land are high enough that the station **does not break even** at any occupancy in the scan: the building is too dear for the rent.

4. Cost-benefit

4.1 Monetised (planning)

	10-year view
Costs (present, t=0)	₦2.57bn cash out
Benefits	Operating FCF Y1–Y9 + Y10 FCF including residual (~₦4.2bn book residual in the model: mix of capitalised EBITDA and land)
NPV @ 22%	– ₦0.71bn
NPV @ 15%	+₦0.16bn
IRR	16%

You are paid for: (1) gates that private BRT/interstate owners will rent because LASTMA wants designated loading and they cannot all afford a Jibowu compound; (2) night waves on the same slab; (3) shops and parking that follow passengers; (4) land that can still be land in year 10.

You pay: a large, illiquid site; political designation; union pressure; diesel; the risk that GIGM-class brands never leave their own lounge.

4.2 Benefit / cost (undiscounted cash, crude)

Ten years of operating FCF before residual is about $₦156 + 289 + 8 \times 396 \approx \textbf{₦3.61bn}$, plus residual **₦4.16bn** at Y10, against **₦2.57bn** in. That looks fat **because residual is large**. Haircut residual to land-only (~₦1.5bn at 7% appreciation on ₦760m) and the story is a **16%-class yield**, not a double-your-money venture. Do not underwrite the residual as if it were cash in year 3.

4.3 Sensitivity (direction)

If this happens	Effect
Land is a concession (upside land line)	NPV @ 22% flips positive
Inner-Lagos freehold (stress land)	Value destroyed even if buses come

If this happens	Effect
Pre-lets fail; occupancy stays ~50%	Stress path — do not open
Night shift cancelled	Lose layover + a large share of casual; IRR drops hard
You take 15% of fares like an old park	Operators stay at Jibowu; “benefit” is imaginary
CNG / workshop later	Extra yield not in the base case

5. Versus owning the buses

Same order of capital: **25 coaches × ₦95m + ₦280m float ≈ ₦2.66bn.**

	Terminus (planning Y3)	Fleet (illustrative, every year)
What you are	Airport	Airline
Gross	₦0.96bn	~₦12.3bn
EBITDA	₦0.54bn (56% margin)	~₦1.36bn (11% margin in this sketch)
NPAT	₦0.31bn	~₦0.72bn
What can wipe it	Empty bays, land price	Fuel, crash, empty return, FX parts, fare war
Residual	Land + a going station	Used iron, eight-year life
Everyday / everyone	The place is used every day by many brands	Only your seats

Paper NPAT is **higher on the fleet**. Quality of earnings, residual, and “piece of whatever comes to the gate” are **better on the station**. Your instinct stands: **do not buy the buses** if the goal is a large, durable take on a daily public flow. The fleet sketch is also **fragile** — 11% EBITDA is a good year, not a covenant.

Do not take a % of their ticket as the core rent. That is how parks get replaced by private compounds. Charge **bays and clock**; own **shops**.

6. The 36 states

Short answer. No — the cash model is **one site**. Yes — the traffic is already **state-to-state across the federation**. Mixing those two is how you either under-claim (only Lagos) or over-build (36 monuments).

6.1 Three different “involve the 36 states”

Meaning	In this CBA?	What it actually is
A. Destinations — buses from this station run to many states, every day	Yes, as the product. Occupancy assumes a mix of East / Abuja / South / North legs, not a Lagos-Ibadan shuttle	One Lagos (or Abuja) hub . Operators hold the other end
B. 36 governments — each state concedes you land	No. Only Lagos or Ogun (the siting state) is the Phase 1 counterparty	A second state appears when you build the pair (e.g. Abuja)
C. 36 termini — copy the yard in every capital	No, and should not be. $36 \times ₦2.57bn \approx ₦92bn$ of concrete. Most capitals cannot fill 36 bays at ₦1.8m/month	Hubs, not a flag in every state

6.2 Why 36 copies fail the same test this CBA already ran

Stress is “expensive land + empty bays.” That is the default in a thin capital. A station in a state with little originating interstate luxury traffic is the stress case **before** you pour. Daily, everyone-uses-it volume in

this country **concentrates**: Lagos as origin, then Abuja, Port Harcourt, Kano, Onitsha/Enugu, Ibadan. The other states are mostly **where the coach is going**, not where you need a 2 ha private ISBT on day one.

6.3 A federation-scale map that can still be true

Phase	Where	Role of the 36 states
1	One Lagos-Ogun (or Abuja) hub	All 36 as possible destinations on tenant routes. One siting government
2	Pair: Lagos and Abuja (or PH)	Two ends of the fattest legs. Two governments, not 36
3	5–8 hubs (add Kano, Enugu/Onitsha, Ibadan, PH if not already)	Covers the corridors that actually run every day. Remaining states stay destinations
Not a phase	One monument per state capital	Political map, not a P&L

Order-of-magnitude for hubs is in \$7. Still only after Phase 1 bays are actually full.

6.4 What to do with state governments

- **Siting state (Lagos or Ogun):** designation, LASTMA, land or concession — this is the only government that can kill or make Phase 1.
- **Destination states:** you do not need their C of O to sell a Lagos bay to a bus going to Enugu. The **operator** already has (or rents) a park there.
- **“Involve 36 states” as a tour of 36 governors:** that is a political campaign, not occupancy. Do not spend the ₦2.57bn on it.

7. Eventual phases

This is the analysis for **getting to the federation without 36 monuments**. Same landlord rules: pre-lets, highway access, night waves. New dirt only after the last hub is **full enough**. Figures from `run_phased()` in the model: six hubs over 12 years, unlevered, bought land (not concession).

7.1 The map

Phase	When (if gates pass)	What you build	CapEx in model	What “36 states” means
0	90 days	Paper: site, designation, ≥15 Lagos bays signed	~0	Routes already list many states
1	Y0–Y3	Lagos-Ogun only (36 bays)	₦2.57bn	Federation as destinations
2	From Y3	Abuja pair (32 bays)	+₦2.56bn	Two ends of the fattest legs
3	From Y5–Y8	PH, Kano, Enugu/Onitsha, Ibadan	+₦6.54bn	6 hubs cover daily corridors
4 (optional)	After Y8	Small spokes (12 bays), only with LOIs	~₦0.79bn each	Next-tier cities, not capitals-for-show
Never	—	36 × Lagos yard	₦92.4bn	Political map. If all ran stress , Y3 EBITDA ≈ –₦6.6bn

Total earned network (Phases 1–3): ₦11.67bn cumulative capital. Not ₦92bn.

7.2 Each hub (planning-class land, thinner occupancy outside Lagos)

Hub	Opens (t)	Bays	Occ.	CapEx	Steady gross	Y12 EBITDA	Y12 NPAT
Lagos-Ogun	0	36	72%	₦2.57bn	₦960m	₦542m	₦310m

Hub	Opens (t)	Bays	Occ.	CapEx	Steady gross	Y12 EBITDA	Y12 NPAT
Abuja	3	32	68%	₦2.56bn	₦845m	₦439m	₦243m
Port Harcourt	5	28	65%	₦1.77bn	₦586m	₦260m	₦133m
Kano	6	28	62%	₦1.67bn	₦509m	₦201m	₦94m
Enugu / Onitsha	7	24	60%	₦1.50bn	₦434m	₦148m	₦61m
Ibadan	8	24	64%	₦1.59bn	₦506m	₦212m	₦105m
Six-hub total		172		₦11.67bn		₦1.80bn	₦946m

Y12 is when all six are at run-rate. Group NPAT ~**₦0.95bn** on ~₦11.7bn in — a ~**8%** after-tax capital yield at the end, worse than **one** fat Lagos station (Y3 NPAT ₦310m on ₦2.57bn ≈ 12%).

7.3 Program cash (12 years)

	Six-hub program
Cumulative CapEx	₦11.67bn
Y12 gross / EBITDA / NPAT	₦3.84bn / ₦1.80bn / ₦946m
Unlevered IRR	12.7%
NPV @ 22%	−₦2.18bn
NPV @ 18%	−₦1.54bn
NPV @ 15%	−₦0.80bn

Read this twice. Spreading into six **bought** yards **dilutes** IRR versus Phase 1 alone (16%). Later hubs have lower occupancy and you spend billions years out. **Do not expand to plant flags.** Expand when the next site is a **concession** (that was the upside that flipped Phase 1 NPV) or when an operator will **pay Lagos-like rent** in that city.

Group NPAT in the model (ops only, ₦ million): Y1 70 → Y3 310 → Y6 549 → Y9 784 → Y12 **946**. The climb is real naira; the **hurdle** is not cleared on bought land.

7.4 Gates (hard)

From → to	Must be true
0 → 1	≥15 Lagos bays contracted; express access; designation
1 → 2	Lagos ≥65% occupancy for 12 months ; ≥20 bays let; books clean
2 → 3	Both Lagos and Abuja ≥60% occ; cash for the next hub without emptying the company
3 → 4 spokes	LOI for ≥8 of 12 bays on that spoke. No paper, no dirt
Any → 36 copies	Never

If Phase 1 misses occupancy, the program **stops**. That is a feature.

7.5 Optional spokes (Phase 4)

Not in the ₦11.67bn. Twelve-bay yard, ~₦793m each, run-rate ~₦229m gross / **₦82m EBITDA** if 70% let.

Eight named cities (Jos, Kaduna, Calabar, Warri, Benin, Maiduguri, Uyo, Asaba) would add ~**₦6.35bn** — only as a list of **options**, each standing on its own pre-let. That still leaves most of the 36 states as **destinations** from the six hubs. That is national coverage.

7.6 How concession changes the phases

Phase 1 **upside** (cheap/concession land) was IRR ~43%. If **each** later hub is a state or LGA concession rather than ~~₦22k–₦48k/m²~~ freehold, the 12.7% program IRR moves **up** and expansion becomes rational. The analysis of “eventual 36 states” is therefore: **hubs on concessions, spokes on pre-lets, everyone else on the timetable.**

8. What the numbers do not capture

Benefits (real, not in NPV)

Everyday infrastructure; many operators under one roof; a file of fleets you could later sell energy or wash to; possible BITP/LAMATA overflow if city terminals clog; inclusion of mid-tier lines that cannot buy Jibowu.

Costs (real, not fully costed)

Union/tout pressure; designation delayed a year (burns the ramp); LASTMA relocates interstate loading to a state box (Oshodi-class) and your highway site is stranded; flood / ROW; you still need the **other city's** park in the operator's network; GIGM already runs tens of **own** lounges — they are not your core tenant.

9. Go / no-go

Question	Answer
Is landlord-not-fleet the right shape?	Yes.
Build on bought outer-Lagos land, no pre-lets, 22% hurdle?	No.
Build if land is concession or cheap edge, ≥40% bays pre-let , you accept ~15-16% IRR as property?	Go — Phase 0.
Inner-city trophy site, Jibowu prices?	No.
Own 25 coaches instead, same cheque?	No if you want residual and sleep. Yes only if you want to be a bus company.
Build 36 state-capital copies to “cover Nigeria”?	No. Cover the federation as destinations from hubs.
Earn Phase 2-3 on bought land like Phase 1 planning?	Not at 15-22%. Six-hub IRR 12.7% , NPV @ 15% still negative. Expand on concessions or stop after a fat pair.

Phase 0 (before ₦2.6bn): 90 days. Site longlist with express access. Counsel on designation. Term sheets from **four operators, ≥15 bays**, routes that already touch many states. Only then buy or concession. Order of spend: **paper, then dirt.**

Capital this year if gates pass: about **₦2.6bn** planning (or ~₦2.0bn if the state holds the land). Second city only after 12 months at ≥65% occupancy. Six-hub **₦11.7bn** is an earned option, not a purchase order. Do not order 36.

10. Appendices

A. Assumptions (planning)

- 36 load bays; 72% contracted; ₦1.8m/bay/month
- Casual: 12 extra departures/day × ₦45,000 × 330 days
- Layover: 18 buses × ₦12,000 × 300 nights
- Retail: 900 m² × 75% occupancy × ₦12,000/m²/month
- Hours that match interstate reality, including night
- Ramp 55% / 80% / 100%

- Residual at Y10: 70% of Y10 EBITDA capitalised at 11% yield + 30% appreciated land and remaining works book
- Rebuild: `python3 model/cba_model.py` (includes `run_phased()` six-hub program)

B. Informal park comparison

Some open parks still take **10-25% of the fare** as a loading fee. That can look richer than ₦1.8m/bay. It is also why serious brands built **private compounds**. This CBA prices a **contracted station** cheap enough versus that tax that operators will come, and rich enough in **retail** that you do not need their ticket.

C. Document control

Version	Date	Notes
1.0	30 Aug 2026	First CBA: landlord interstate terminus vs fleet; three cases
1.1	30 Aug 2026	36 states: destinations on the timetable, not 36 copies of the yard
1.2	30 Aug 2026	Eventual phases: 1 hub → pair → 6 hubs (₦11.7bn); spokes optional; 36 copies still a no

Next refresh: named site and asking price; four operator term sheets; designation memo.